

Activity 08: Coaching and Performance Conversation

Leadership Masterclass · C904 · v4.0 · Fictional practice material

Goal

In this activity, you will create ownership through questions using a fictional Meridian Services situation. You will discuss different perspectives, practise a leadership response and produce a reusable work artifact. The exercise connects the topic concepts to an everyday team decision, and the debrief focuses on how your response affects other people.

What you will build

A completed coaching and performance conversation worksheet, a peer observation checklist and a practical next action.

Fictional scenario

An analyst has missed two quality checks while covering for an absent colleague. They want to improve but feel overloaded. A manager's immediate suggestion is to work faster.

Preparation

Read the scenario. Open [worksheet.docx](#) or print [worksheet.pdf](#). Work in pairs or triads. Use [sample-completed-worksheet.pdf](#) after making your own first attempt.

Step 1

Ask the learner playing the analyst to define the desired outcome.

Step 2

Explore facts, workload and resources without assuming a lack of effort.

Step 3

Ask for at least two options before suggesting advice.

Step 4

Agree one small trial, the leader's support and an observable review measure.

Step 5

Swap roles and reflect on when coaching, mentoring or a direct instruction would be appropriate.

Test it

Check each item in checklist.md, then ask a peer to identify one clear strength and one concrete improvement. Confirm that your proposed action has an owner and a review point.

Debrief

What evidence changed your view? Which trade-off remains? Which behaviour will you practise next?